

Child safeguarding standards

1. Purpose and scope. Every child, meaning a person under 18, has a right to safety, dignity and help. These standards cover staff, contractors and contact with children at Hornigold, Kopernika 6, Katowice, operated by the company identified in the legal information. Version: 9 October 2026. Basis: the Polish Act of 13 May 2016 on preventing sexual offences and protecting minors, as amended.
2. Responsibility and reporting. The company management board oversees implementation. The property manager coordinates the standards; in their absence the reception shift lead receives reports and escalates them to the board. Every staff member must respond. A child, carer or witness may approach reception, call +48 608 662 707 or email office@hornigold.pl. In immediate danger call 112 without waiting for email. Bypass any person implicated in a report: contact management, the board or competent authorities.
3. Safe relationships. Staff must be respectful and must not discriminate, use violence, humiliate, threaten, sexualise, bribe or demand secrecy. Sexual contact, unrelated private messaging and photographing children on personal devices are prohibited. Physical contact is limited to justified assistance with respect for consent and boundaries; necessary emergency help must not be delayed. Avoid being alone with a child in a closed space. Never blame a child for reporting harm.
4. Arrival checks. Reception establishes the identity of the child and accompanying adult, their relationship and authority to care, explaining why questions are asked. Use lawful, proportionate documents or explanations and respect privacy. Appearance or surnames alone do not establish a relationship. Do not routinely copy identity documents or request them by ordinary email. Missing documents alone are not proof of abuse. Escalate unresolved concerns to management and suspected danger to authorities. Staff must not use force or conduct their own investigation.
5. Listening and warning signs. Respond to disclosures, fear, injuries, controlled speech or other concerning behaviour without stereotyping by origin, disability or clothing. Listen calmly, reassure the child they are not at fault, avoid leading questions and repeated detailed accounts. Do not promise absolute secrecy: explain that information will reach the people needed to help.
6. Emergency action. For danger to life or health call 112 immediately, give Kopernika 6, Katowice, provide help within competence and arrange a calm safe place without putting anyone at further risk. Where safe alternative care is possible, do not leave the child with a suspected abuser. Do not attempt forcible detention. Management notifies Police or prosecutors of suspected offences and the competent family court when required. Urgent action and legally required reporting do not depend on carer consent or prior managerial approval.
7. Suspected persons and support. Management removes an implicated staff member from contact with the child while concerns are examined, without prejudging guilt. Where a carer is suspected, avoid disclosures or confrontation that increase danger. Arrange further assistance and safe handover with a safe carer and authorities. The property does not replace Police, courts or specialist therapy. Good-faith reporting must not lead to retaliation.

8. Records and data. The recipient makes a confidential note of date, time, place, observations or exact words, actions, notifications and author, separating facts from opinions. Management maintains a restricted incident register. Record only information needed for safeguarding and legal duties; health and alleged-offence data need particular protection and a lawful basis. No public register or personal-device copies. Retention follows the legal basis, proceedings and claim periods, with at least an annual necessity review. Share only with authorised people and competent authorities.

9. Individual needs. Adapt assistance to age, language, disability and additional needs. Use simple explanations, a calm place and suitable communication support where possible. A suspected person must not interpret for the child. Speech or communication difficulties do not make a child unreliable. A carer cannot prevent a danger report.

10. Internet, images and peers. Do not expose children to sexual or violent content or solicit private online contact. Publishing their image requires an appropriate basis and respect for their wishes; a stay is not consent to marketing photos. Respond to peer violence by ensuring safety and informing safe carers or authorities. No network filtering or continuous monitoring of guest devices is claimed.

11. Staff and review. Management records named role holders and deputies internally, briefs staff before contact with children and documents training and acknowledgements. Legally required checks for people undertaking covered activities must be performed within the applicable scope; this document is not proof that checks occurred. Review at least every two years and after material incidents or legal changes, documenting and implementing conclusions.

12. Availability. Full and child-friendly versions are available online for download and printing. Management must display them visibly at the property and provide them to staff. Children may give feedback to reception or management. Help in Poland: 112 for emergencies; 116 111 for children and young people; 800 12 12 12 for the Children's Ombudsman helpline. Support lines do not replace emergency 112.